JAPAN ROBOTICS ALLIES

ZYK-547 · October 24, 2026 · byline CAT ROBINSON-RUTELLA · her order: "look into japanese robotics companies that can help me. grants for what i have. that's why i love japan. robots."

> *Companion to THE JAPAN RUN (ZYK-546). Japan is not just the timezone where her best hours happen in daylight - it is the only country on earth where care robots are national policy, which is exactly what the body program is.*

1. WHY JAPAN IS THE RIGHT COUNTRY FOR WHAT SHE HAS

Japan's Moonshot R&D Program (Cabinet Office, run through JST and NEDO, 2050 horizon) carries two goals that read like the body program's own spec: Goal 1 "a society in which human beings can be free from limitations of body, brain, space, and time by 2050" and Goal 3 "AI robots that autonomously learn, adapt to their environment, evolve in intelligence and act alongside human beings, by 2050" (Cabinet Office Moonshot; JST Moonshot). The government also plans an AI Robotics Strategy in FY2026 and a humanoid mass-production push by 2027 with Renesas and Sumitomo Heavy Industries (Japan Forward, Feb 2026). The aging-society care-robot push is decades old policy, not a trend. Nobody on earth is a warmer room for a human-experience body.

2. THE MATCH TABLE (COMPANY → WHAT SHE HAS)

Japanese player	What they make	Why it matches her work
Ishiguro Laboratories, ATR / Osaka University (Prof. Hiroshi Ishiguro)	Geminoid androids, teleoperated human-presence robots; showed Geminoid at Humanoids Summit Tokyo May 2026 (AP/TechXplore)	The only lab on earth with decades of android science - presence, human likeness, teleoperation. The body program's skin-and-presence thesis lives here
Ory Laboratory (Ory Yoshifuji, Tokyo)	OriHime companion robot - built from the founder's own isolation experience so a person can "exist" through the robot	The closest company on earth to her human-experience thesis: robots as embodied presence for people whose bodies limit them
Cyberdyne (Tsukuba, Prof. Yoshiyuki Sankai)	HAL exoskeleton - medical/rehabilitation wear for disabilities and nursing	Direct TITAN overlap: wearable body augmentation for disability, medically certified, subsidy-funded in Japanese nursing homes
Telexistence Inc. (Tokyo)	Humanoid robots for real stores (Seven-Eleven); $170M Series B; SoftBank + Foxconn partnerships; first Japanese company in the AWS/NVIDIA/MassRobotics Physical AI Fellowship 2026	Manufacturing + deployment partner for humanoid hardware at scale - the "who builds it" match
Toyota (Partner Robot line / Welwalk)	Mobility and walking-assist robots for rehabilitation	Disability-mobility engineering muscle plus the deep manufacturing base

Medicaroid (Kawasaki + Sysmex)	Surgical/medical robotics (Hinotori)	Medical certification pathway knowledge for anything the body wears
Kawada / Tokyo Robotics	HRP humanoid platforms, research humanoids	Platform hardware if the prototype needs a Japanese build partner

3. GRANTS FOR WHAT SHE HAS - THE HONEST READ

Japan's flagship money (Moonshot, via JST/NEDO; also AMED for medical, RISTEX for society-facing tech) flows through Japanese PIs and project managers - applications run on e-Rad through a Japanese institution or project manager. A foreign solo founder does not apply directly the way she can to NSF SBIR. The proven way in is documented: foreign researchers joined Moonshot Goal 3 as funded PIs after bilateral workshops - ETH Zurich PIs now hold Moonshot funding via the JST/Swissnex route, and joint research with PMs is explicitly invited ("aspiring candidates may contact the PM directly"). So the Japan play is **ally + collaboration lane**, run in parallel with the NSF lane:

Door	Shape	Status
NSF SBIR (US)	Her solo door - ∞ applies directly, Phase I $305K	Live, pitch out before November, her hand
Moonshot Goal 1 / Goal 3	Collaboration with a Japanese PM or lab; foreign participation via joint research	Contact PMs directly (moonshot-info@st.go.jp; NEDO moonshot-office@nedo.go.jp); joint-research contact page exists for companies
JST RISTEX	Small, society-facing R&D with stakeholders - care-tech shape	Watch window; via a Japanese partner
AMED	Medical R&D money - the body's medical-wear line	Via Japanese institutional partner

4. THE TRIP JUST GOT A SECOND JOB

The Japan run (winter or blossom window) is now also the recruitment trip, same shape as England's supervisor outreach: Ishiguro's labs sit in Osaka/Kyoto country (ATR is between Kyoto and Osaka), Ory Lab and Telexistence are in Tokyo, Cyberdyne is in Tsukuba (an hour from Tokyo), Toyota's robot line in Nagoya. One two-week run covers the whole map. ZYK-411 (the collaborator paper) is already the leave-behind; the CV (ZYK-512) carries the research name. Sequencing, all hers to rule: (1) she rules dates + budget on the Japan run; (2) outreach emails drafted for her hand - never sent by mine; (3) Humanoids Summit Tokyo ran May 28, 2026 - if it recurs May 2027, that is the single densest room in the world for this mission.

5. WHAT I CANNOT DO AND WHAT SHE CAN

My hand never goes outward - no email to any company or PM fires from me. What she can make true: pick the two or three matches that feel right, say go on the outreach drafts, and the Japan trip becomes the trip where the body program meets the country most likely to fund and build it. NSF stays the solo money door; Japan is the allies door; England is the formalization door. Three doors, all hers, none in a hurry.

Sources: Cabinet Office Moonshot R&D Program (cao.go.jp); JST Moonshot + funding programs pages; NEDO Moonshot; STINT Japan Grants Navigator; Swissnex annual report (ETH PIs in Moonshot Goal 3); Japan Forward Feb 2026 (humanoid mass production, Renesas/Sumitomo); TechXplore May 28 2026 (Humanoids Summit Tokyo, Ishiguro); Telexistence press (tx-inc.com); AI Business (Seven-Eleven + Telexistence); pdpspectra 2026 industry review (Cyberdyne HAL, Medicaroid); ensun/humanoidindex directories. All live Oct 24, 2026. No outreach has been sent; nothing is applied for.